Neo Smart Living — Tahoe Mini Survey

Welcome, and thank you for your interest in this study!

Neo Smart Living is a Southern California company that designs and installs compact, factory-built backyard units — standalone studios, workspaces, and guest rooms that can be set up in most backyards within a single day, often without a building permit.

As more homeowners look for flexible ways to add usable space — whether for remote work, creative pursuits, hosting guests, or simply having a private retreat — we want to understand what matters most to people like you. Your honest feedback will directly shape how Neo Smart Living develops, positions, and delivers its products.

This survey will take approximately **8–10 minutes** to complete. You will be asked about your interest in backyard structures, your reactions to different product concepts, and some basic background information.

Your responses are completely anonymous and will only be used for research purposes. As a thank-you, you will have the option to enter a drawing for one of three **$50 Amazon gift cards** at the end of the survey.

There are no right or wrong answers — we are simply interested in your genuine opinions and preferences.

Thank you for your time!

Joint study by:

Cal Poly Pomona - Marketing Research Class (Dr. Lin)

Neo Smart Living

aytm

* Indicates required question

1. Email *

https://www.neosmartliving.com/

Section A: Screening

2. S3. Outdoor space feasibility *

Does your property have any outdoor area where a small detached structure (approximately 9 ft × 13 ft / about 117 sq ft — roughly the size of a standard backyard storage shed or compact home office) could potentially be placed (e.g., backyard, side yard, front setback where allowed, large patio, detached pad, unused lot area)?

Mark only one oval.

- Yes *Skip to question 3*
- I'm not sure, but possibly *Skip to question 3*
- No *Skip to section 3 (Thank You)*

Thank You

This survey focuses on properties with outdoor space for a detached structure. Thank you for your time.

Section B: Category Baseline (Pre-Exposure)

3. Q0a. Prior consideration *

Have you ever looked into or considered adding a small detached structure — such as a backyard studio, workspace, or factory-built units — to your property? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- Yes, I have actively researched or priced options
- Yes, I have thought about it but not researched it
- I'm aware it's possible but haven't seriously considered it
- No, I have never considered this

4. Q0b. Category interest *

How interested are you — in general — in adding a compact factory-built backyard unit (a standalone studio, not a full room addition or permitted dwelling) to your property in the next 2 years?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely interested

Section C: Product Stimulus

Product Description — Tahoe Mini by Neo Smart Living

The Tahoe Mini is a compact 117-square-foot factory-built backyard unit — designed as a private, standalone studio, workspace, or guestroom. It measures approximately 9 ft × 13 ft (roughly the footprint of a standard backyard storage shed) and features a bright, open layout. It is delivered as flat-packed panels and can be installed in most backyards — even those with limited access — typically within one day. The approximate price is $23,000 including sales tax, delivery, installation, and warranty.

A key differentiator of the Tahoe Mini is its modular construction system. The wall panels are interchangeable and configurable, allowing customers to customize window placement, wall composition, and layout orientation based on their specific backyard setup and intended use. This modular flexibility allows the structure to adapt to different lifestyle needs — whether maximizing natural light, increasing privacy, or optimizing wall space for shelving, desks, or creative equipment.

The Tahoe Mini is **NOT** an ADU (Accessory Dwelling Unit). It does not include plumbing or a kitchen and is classified as a non-habitable accessory structure — a premium modular space, not a permitted living unit. At 117 sq ft, it is intentionally sized under California's ~120 sq ft threshold, which means it often does not require a building permit (though local city ordinances and HOA rules should always be verified).

Standard features include pre-wired electrical, smart entry lock, dual-pane floor-to-ceiling glass, a pitched roof with drainage, and optional upgrades such as sound insulation and heating/cooling.

Tahoe Mini by Neo Smart Living

Section D: Market Demand & Purchase Feasibility

5. Q1. Purchase interest at $23,000 *

Based on the product description above, how interested would you be in purchasing and installing a Tahoe Mini at the approximately $23,000 delivered-and-installed price point?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely interested

6. Q2. Purchase likelihood (24-month horizon) *

How likely are you to purchase a Tahoe Mini within the next 24 months?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

7. Q3. Primary intended use *

If you were to install a Tahoe Mini, what would be its primary use? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- Home office / remote workspace
- Guest suite / short-term rental (STR) income
- Wellness studio (gym, yoga, meditation)
- Adventure basecamp (gear storage, bike workshop, hangout space)
- General storage / premium "speed shed"
- Creative studio (music, podcast, art)
- Children's playroom
- Other: _____

8. Q5. Barrier severity matrix *

Below is a list of potential concerns a homeowner might have about purchasing a backyard prefab unit. For each, please indicate how strongly it would reduce your likelihood of purchasing the Tahoe Mini.
(1 = Would not reduce my likelihood at all, 5 = Would strongly reduce my likelihood)

Mark only one oval per row.

	1	2	3	4	5
The total cost (~$23,000)					
HOA restrictions or community rules					
Uncertainty about whether a building permit is required					
Limited backyard space or access					
Lack of financing options					
Concerns about build quality or durability					
Uncertainty about resale value					

9. Q5b. Other barrier (optional)

If you have another concern not listed above, please describe it and rate its severity (1–5).

10. Q6. Single greatest barrier *

Which one barrier above would be the single greatest obstacle preventing you from purchasing a Tahoe Mini? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- The total cost (~$23,000)
- HOA restrictions or community rules
- Uncertainty about whether a building permit is required
- Limited backyard space or access
- Lack of financing options
- Concerns about build quality or durability
- Uncertainty about resale value
- None — I have no significant concerns
- Other:

Section E: Positioning Concept Test

Instructions

You will now read five short descriptions of different ways the Tahoe Mini could be positioned and marketed. After reading each one, please rate (a) how appealing the concept is and (b) how likely you would be to purchase the Tahoe Mini if it were marketed that way.

Concept 1: Backyard Home Office

"Work smarter — right in your backyard." Turn your backyard into a quiet, dedicated office with the Tahoe Mini. Get the separation you need for focus, calls, and creativity — without renovating your home or giving up a bedroom. A clean, comfortable space designed for real workdays.

11. Q9a. How appealing is this concept to you personally? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely appealing

12. Q9b. If the Tahoe Mini were marketed this way, how likely would you be to purchase it? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

Concept 2: Guest Suite / STR Income

"Add space for guests — or extra income." The Tahoe Mini creates a private backyard suite for visiting family, friends, or short-term stays. Expand your home's flexibility without a major remodel. A comfortable, separate space that can help you host better — and potentially offset costs with rental income.

13. Q10a. How appealing is this concept to you personally? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely appealing

14. Q10b. If the Tahoe Mini were marketed this way, how likely would you be to purchase it? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

Concept 3: Wellness / Studio Space

"Your personal studio — steps from your door." Build a dedicated space for the routines that keep you feeling your best. The Tahoe Mini gives you a backyard gym, yoga studio, or creative retreat — private, motivating, and always available. A place to reset, train, create, and recharge.

15. Q11a. How appealing is this concept to you personally? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely appealing

16. Q11b. If the Tahoe Mini were marketed this way, how likely would you be to purchase it? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

Concept 4: Adventure Lifestyle / Community

"Basecamp for your passions." Whether it's bikes, boards, or weekend gear, the Tahoe Mini adds a backyard "basecamp" for adventure and community. Store, tune, plan, and hang out — then head out. Built for active lifestyles and the groups that live for the outdoors.

17. Q12a. How appealing is this concept to you personally? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely appealing

18. Q12b. If the Tahoe Mini were marketed this way, how likely would you be to purchase it? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

Concept 5: Simplicity (Transparency + Speed + Less Headache)

"Skip the stress of traditional building." Traditional construction can mean surprises, delays, and changing costs. The Tahoe Mini offers a simpler path to adding usable space — built with a more streamlined, factory-controlled process designed to reduce hassle and uncertainty. Get the space you want with a smoother experience.

19. Q13a. How appealing is this concept to you personally? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Not	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Extremely appealing

20. Q13b. If the Tahoe Mini were marketed this way, how likely would you be to purchase it? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Defi	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Definitely would

21. Q14. Overall concept preference *

Of the five concepts you just reviewed, which one would most strongly motivate you to purchase the Tahoe Mini? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- ◯ Concept 1: Backyard Home Office ("Work smarter — right in your backyard")
- ◯ Concept 2: Guest Suite / STR Income ("Add space for guests — or extra income")
- ◯ Concept 3: Wellness / Studio Space ("Your personal studio — steps from your door")
- ◯ Concept 4: Adventure Lifestyle / Community ("Basecamp for your passions")
- ◯ Concept 5: Simplicity ("Skip the stress of traditional building")
- ◯ None of the above — I would not be motivated by any of these

Section F: Value Driver Test

Instructions

Neo Smart Living emphasizes several key advantages of the Tahoe Mini. For each one below, please rate how strongly it would increase your likelihood of purchasing.

22. Q15. Permit-light positioning *

"At 117 sq ft, the Tahoe Mini is sized to typically avoid California building permit requirements — saving you time, paperwork, and uncertainty."

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Does	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Very strongly increases

23. Q16. Installation speed *

"The Tahoe Mini is delivered as flat-packed panels and can typically be installed in your backyard within a single day. Neo Smart Living maintains local inventory for weekly installs."

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Does	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Very strongly increases

24. Q17. Build quality and details *

"The Tahoe Mini comes standard with pre-wired electrical, dual-pane floor to ceiling glass, a pitched roof with drainage, and optional upgrades like sound insulation, and heating/cooling — built in a factory-controlled environment for consistent quality."

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Doe	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Very strongly increases

25. Q17b. Smart Technology *

"The Tahoe Mini integrates with smart home systems and features energy-efficient controls for lighting, climate, and security."

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Doe	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Very strongly increases

26. Q17c. Showroom *

"Neo Smart Living has dedicated showrooms in key markets, allowing you to see and experience the quality of the Tahoe Mini before purchase."

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Doe	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯	Very strongly increases

27. Q18. Most persuasive value driver *

Which value driver most increases your purchase likelihood? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- Permit-light positioning
- Installation speed
- Build quality and details
- Next day delivery
- Smart Technology
- Showroom
- Other: _____

Section G: Adventure Sponsorship Decision Support

28. Q19. Sponsorship impact on trust and purchase interest *

If Neo Smart Living partnered with local outdoor clubs or events (e.g., mountain bike group rides, hiking meetups, outdoor festivals), how would that affect your trust in the brand and your purchase interest?

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Deci						Increase a lot

29. Q20. Most effective outreach channel *

Which outreach methods would most likely get your attention for a product like the Tahoe Mini? (Select up to 3.)

Check all that apply.

- [ ] Outdoor club sponsorships / community events
- [ ] Social media ads (Facebook, Instagram)
- [ ] Social media posts on vendor accounts (e.g., Neo Smart Living's Instagram, Facebook, TikTok)
- [ ] YouTube videos (reviews, walkthroughs, install timelapses)
- [ ] Google / Search ads
- [ ] Home improvement expos
- [ ] Real estate partner referrals
- [ ] Neighborhood / Nextdoor recommendations
- [ ] Online reviews / rating sites
- [ ] Friend / family referral
- [ ] Other: _____

Section H: Demographics & Classification

30. Q21. Age *

What is your age?

Mark only one oval.

- ( ) 18–24
- ( ) 25–34
- ( ) 35–44
- ( ) 45–54
- ( ) 55–64
- ( ) 65 or older

31. Q21b. Gender *

What is your gender? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- Male
- Female
- Non-binary / third gender
- Prefer not to say
- Other: _____

32. Q21c. Ethnicity *

Which of the following best describes your racial or ethnic background? (Select all that apply.)

Check all that apply.

- [ ] White / Caucasian
- [ ] Hispanic / Latino
- [ ] Black / African American
- [ ] Asian / Asian American
- [ ] Native American / Alaska Native
- [ ] Native Hawaiian / Pacific Islander
- [ ] Middle Eastern / North African
- [ ] Multiracial / Biracial
- [ ] Prefer not to say
- [ ] Other: _____

33. Q21d. Job / profession *

Which of the following best describes your current job or professional field? (Select one.)

Mark only one oval.

- Technology / IT
- Healthcare / Medical
- Education
- Finance / Accounting / Insurance
- Real estate / Construction
- Creative / Design / Media
- Sales / Marketing
- Legal
- Trades / Skilled labor
- Government / Public sector
- Self-employed / Small business owner
- Student
- Retired (no current profession)
- Prefer not to say
- Other: _____

34. Q22. Household income *

What is your annual household income before taxes?

Mark only one oval.

- Under $50,000
- $50,000–$74,999
- $75,000–$99,999
- $100,000–$149,999
- $150,000–$199,999
- $200,000 or more
- Prefer not to say

35. Q23. Work arrangement *

Which best describes your current work arrangement?

Mark only one oval.

- I work remotely full-time (5 days/week from home)
- I work a hybrid schedule (at least part of my week is remote)
- I work on-site / in-person full-time
- I am self-employed / freelance (primarily work from home)
- I am retired
- I am not currently employed

36. Q24. HOA status *

Is your home subject to a Homeowners Association (HOA)?

Mark only one oval.

- Yes
- No
- I'm not sure

37. Q25. Outdoor recreation frequency *

How frequently do you participate in outdoor recreation activities (e.g., mountain biking, hiking, trail running, surfing, camping)?

Mark only one oval.

- Never
- A few times a year
- About once a month
- 2–3 times per month
- Weekly or more

38. Q26. Outdoor club membership *

Are you currently a member of any organized outdoor recreation club or community group (e.g., a mountain bike club, hiking group, running club, outdoor yoga group)? If yes, please specify as "IE MTB Club" or in the 'Other'.

Mark only one oval.

- No
- Yes - IE MTB Club
- Other: _____

Section I: Data Quality

39. Q30. Attention check *

To confirm attention, please select "Moderately interested."

Mark only one oval.

- Not at all interested
- Slightly interested
- Moderately interested
- Very interested
- Extremely interested

Section J: Gift Card Drawing & Contact Permission

40. Q31. Gift card drawing

To thank you for your time, we are offering a chance to win three $50 gift cards. If you would like to enter the drawing, please provide your email address below.

Your email will only be used for the gift card drawing and will not be linked to your survey responses.

Leave blank if you do not wish to enter.

41. Q32. Contact permission (optional)

Neo Smart Living is exploring ways to better serve homeowners like you. Would you be open to being contacted with product updates, special offers, or an invitation to visit a showroom?

This is entirely optional and will not affect your gift card entry.

Mark only one oval.

- Yes — please contact me by email
- Yes — please contact me by phone
- Yes — please contact me by either email or phone
- No, I prefer not to be contacted

42. Q32b. Contact phone or email (if you selected email or either above)

43. Who referred you to fill out the survey? *

Mark only one oval.

- Dr. Yufan (Frank) Lin
- IE MTB Club
- Aaron Jasso
- Alejandro Reyes
- Andrea Cabrera
- Ashley Sanchez
- Briana Frontuto
- Christian Salas
- Claudia Flores
- Diego Gutierrez
- Dominyck Ivers
- Duke Kim
- Ethan Ticich
- Gleizette Edquid
- Harrison Gan
- Isaiah Alvarez
- Jeffrey McCulloch
- Jeffrey McCulloch
- Kevin Zhou
- Laryssa Ortiz
- Manyu Yara
- Marcos Anton

- Matthew Woodward
- Mauricio Arroyo
- Mauricio Arroyo
- Michael Martinez
- Mia Mota
- Mia Mota
- Nina Puckett
- Nour Ali
- Nour Ali
- Ozzy Cuellar
- Paulina Vazquez
- Sean Changizi
- Test
- Other:

44. Q33. Final feedback (optional)

Is there anything else you would like to share about the Tahoe Mini, your experience with this survey, or what would influence your decision to add a backyard unit to your property?

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